

CASE STUDY · Q1 2016

BrightTV

Viewership Analytics

Insights to grow BrightTV's subscription base — prepared for the CVM team

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What we'll cover today

A data-driven journey through BrightTV's Q1 2016 viewership — built to answer four core business questions.

01

The Landscape

Who are BrightTV's users and how do they behave?

02

What Drives Consumption?

Factors that increase and decrease viewing

03

Low-Day Opportunities

What content can close the Monday gap?

04

Growing the User Base

Initiatives to acquire and re-engage subscribers

By the numbers

Q1 2016 at a glance — January through March



10,000

Total sessions

Jan - Mar 2016



4,386

Active users

of 5,375 registered



9.1 min

Avg session length

Median: 1.8 min



3 PM

Peak hour (SA time)

648 sessions



92.4%

Short sessions (<30 min)

Channel-surfing behaviour



989

Dormant users

Never watched — re-engage

01

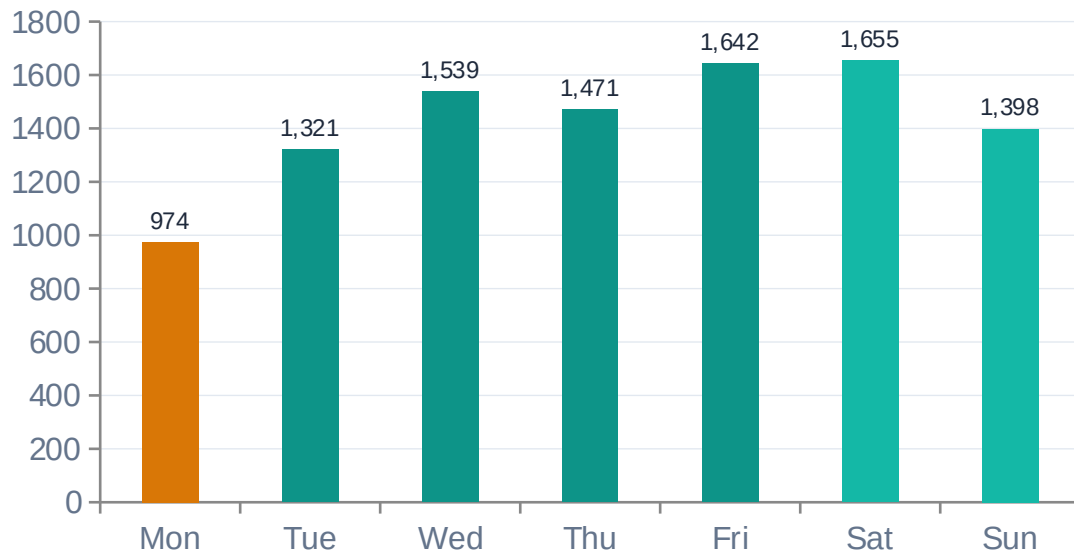
The Landscape

Who are BrightTV's users, and how do they behave?

Viewership trends

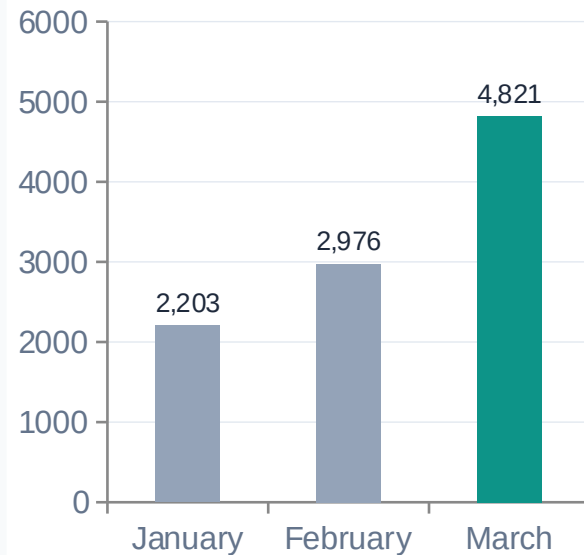
Sessions spike through the quarter — with one clear weekly weak spot

Sessions by day of week



Monday records only 974 sessions — 41% below Saturday's peak of 1,655. This is BrightTV's biggest single-day opportunity.

Sessions by month

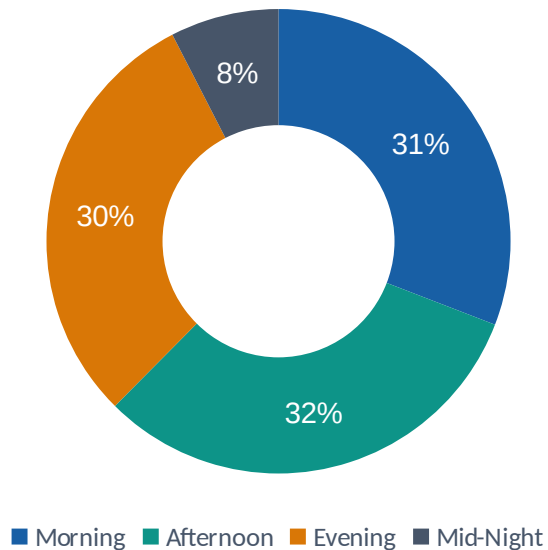


March is +119% vs January — cricket viewership drove the surge.

When people watch

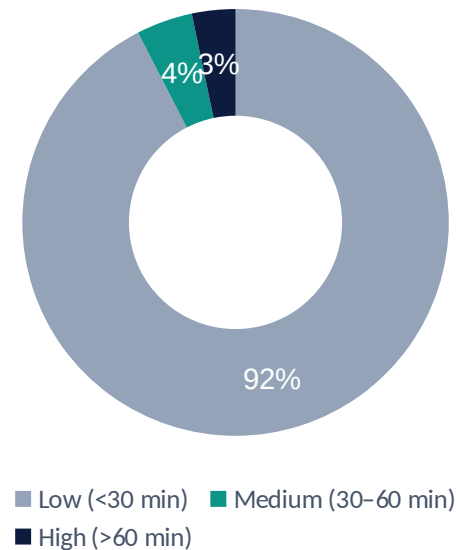
The viewing day peaks from 10am through 6pm — afternoons and mornings dominate

Sessions by time of day



Afternoon (3,160) + Morning (3,085) = 62% of all sessions. Push notifications at 9–10am can intercept viewers just before peak.

Session length distribution

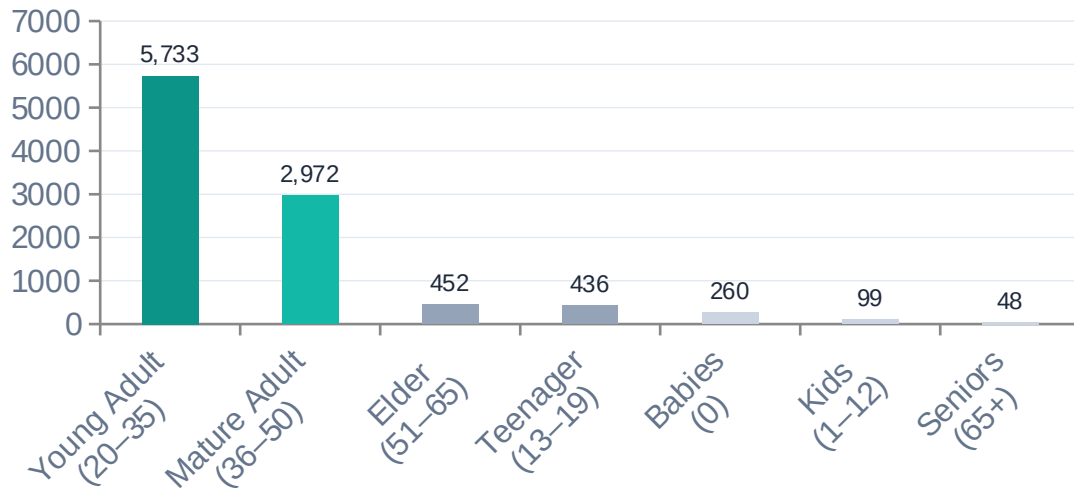


92.4% of sessions are under 30 minutes. This signals channel-surfing — auto-play and recommendations would directly increase depth.

Who is watching?

Young, male, and concentrated in Gauteng — with significant untapped segments

Sessions by age group



88%

Male viewers

8,761 sessions — sports dominated



10%

Female viewers

977 sessions — underserved segment



37%

Gauteng share

3,654 of 10,000 sessions



57%

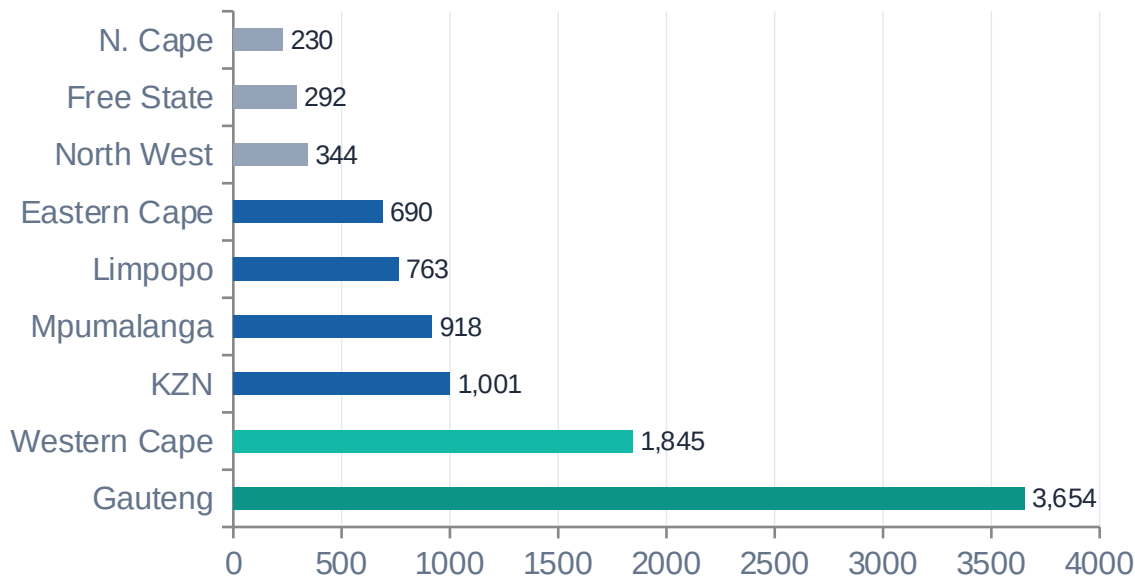
Core age group

Young Adults (20-35)

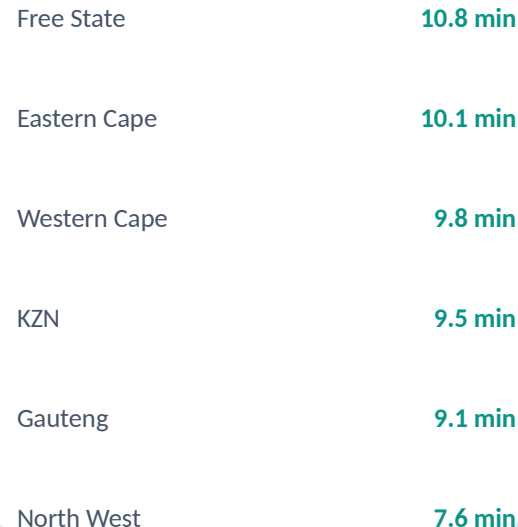
Where sessions come from

Two provinces drive more than half of all viewership — the other seven are growth opportunities

Sessions by province



Engagement quality by province



Free State and Eastern Cape viewers watch the longest per session — high quality engagement despite lower session volumes. These provinces need reach, not content changes.

What Drives Consumption?

The factors that push viewership up — and pull it down

Factors that influence viewing

Six measurable drivers — positive and negative — extracted from the data



↑ Driver

Day of week

Friday & Saturday deliver 33% more sessions than Monday & Tuesday. The weekly rhythm is consistent and predictable.



↑ Driver

Age segment

Young Adults (20–35) account for 57% of sessions. Kids deliver the longest sessions at 12.8 min average — highest engagement.



↓ Friction

Geography

Gauteng alone = 37% of all sessions. Urban concentration drives high session volume but limits national reach.



↓ Friction

Gender gap

Male viewers = 88% of sessions. Female viewers represent only 10% — an underserved audience with clear content preferences.



↓ Friction

Content type

Sports content drives 57% of watch time. When live sport isn't on (Mondays), viewership drops sharply — a content dependency risk.



↓ Friction

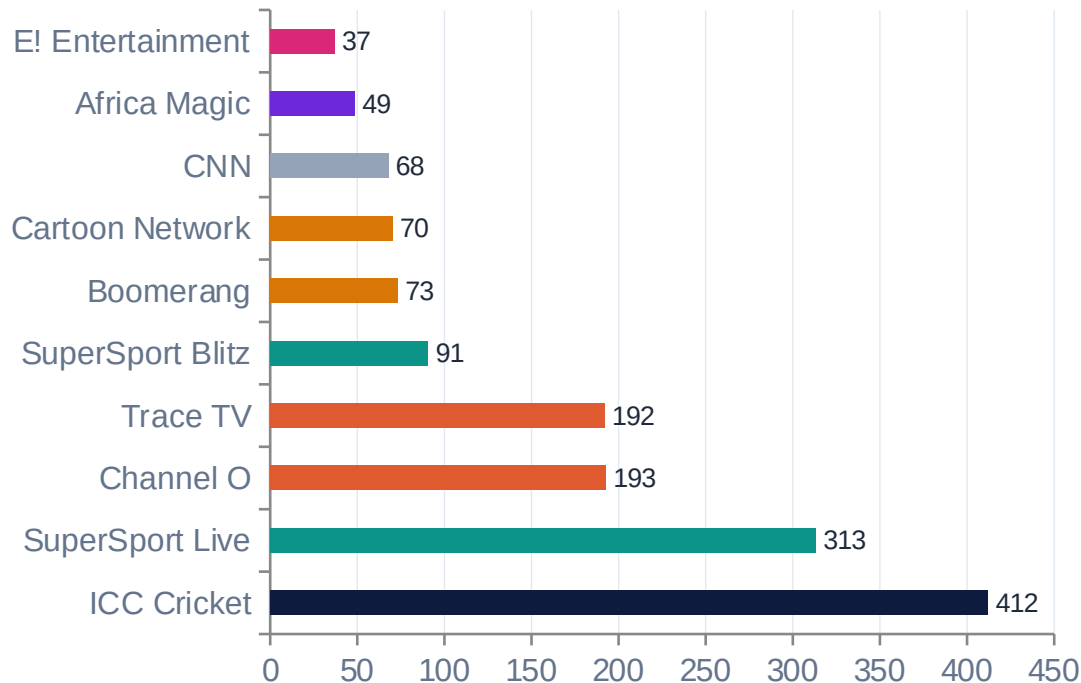
Session depth

92% of sessions under 30 minutes. Auto-play and personalised recommendations are absent — a product gap costing total watch time.

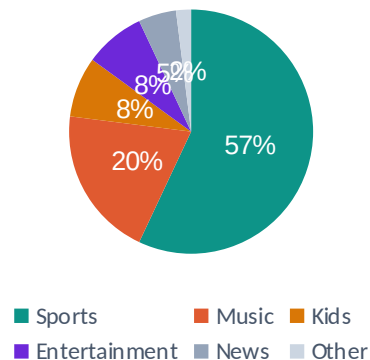
What people are watching

Sports dominates total watch time — but music and kids content punch above their weight

Top 10 channels — total watch time (hours)



By content type



Key observation

Music channels (Channel O + Trace TV) combined = 32% of watch time. They are the clear #2 content bloc — and the dominant choice when sports isn't available.

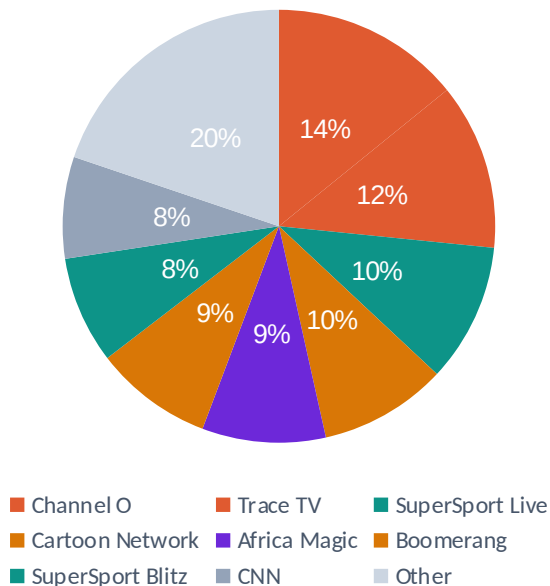
Low-Day Opportunities

What content can close the Monday gap — and boost slow periods?

Diagnosing the Monday problem

Monday is a content vacuum — but the audience is still there, just not engaged

What viewers watch on Mondays



1

Music event nights

Partner with local artists for Monday-exclusive premieres on Channel O or Trace TV. Music already leads on Mondays — lean into it.

2

Drama & reality series

Schedule new episode drops on Mondays. Weekly appointment viewing creates a habit that pulls people in on the weakest day.

3

Curated throwback content

Classic football highlights, iconic cricket matches, or documentary-style sports content fills the live sports gap without requiring new rights.

4

Family & kids block

Monday afternoons (school pickup time). Cartoon Network + Boomerang already perform. A promoted family block builds the kids & parents segment simultaneously.

Growing the User Base

Initiatives to acquire new subscribers and re-engage those we've already won

Six growth initiatives for CVM

Prioritised by impact and speed-to-execute — actionable for this financial year

1

Quick win

Re-engage 989 dormant users

All dormant users have email + social flags. A personalised win-back campaign ("we miss you") with a content hook is low-cost and measurable within weeks.

2

High impact

Female audience strategy

Build a content vertical around Africa Magic, drama, and lifestyle. Target via social media (female audiences over-index on Instagram and Facebook). Aim to move from 10% to 20%+ female share.

3

Growth

Provincial expansion — KZN, Limpopo, Mpumalanga

These three provinces have SA's fastest-growing urban populations but underperform on BrightTV. Local content partnerships and regional campaigns can shift the balance.

4

Product

Push notifications at the morning rise

Sessions build sharply from 8–10am. A personalised notification at 9am ("Good morning — here's what's on") intercepts viewers at the exact moment they're forming their viewing habit.

5

Product

Auto-play and recommendation engine

92% of sessions end under 30 minutes. Auto-play next episode and a personalised homepage could double average watch time without acquiring a single new user.

6

Long term

Kids content investment

Kids average the longest sessions (12.8 min) of any age group. Investing in kids content converts one subscriber into a family, dramatically increasing household LTV.

The bottom line

Four answers to the CEO's question — how do we grow this year?



Fix Monday

Music events, drama drops, and family blocks can lift BrightTV's weakest day by an estimated 25–40%.



Win female viewers

From 10% to 20%+ female share means 1,000+ new monthly sessions without adding a single male subscriber.



Go national

KZN, Limpopo and Mpumalanga are the next subscriber frontier — high population, low penetration.



Deepen engagement

Auto-play + recommendations + morning push = longer sessions + re-activated dormant users. ROI without new spend.